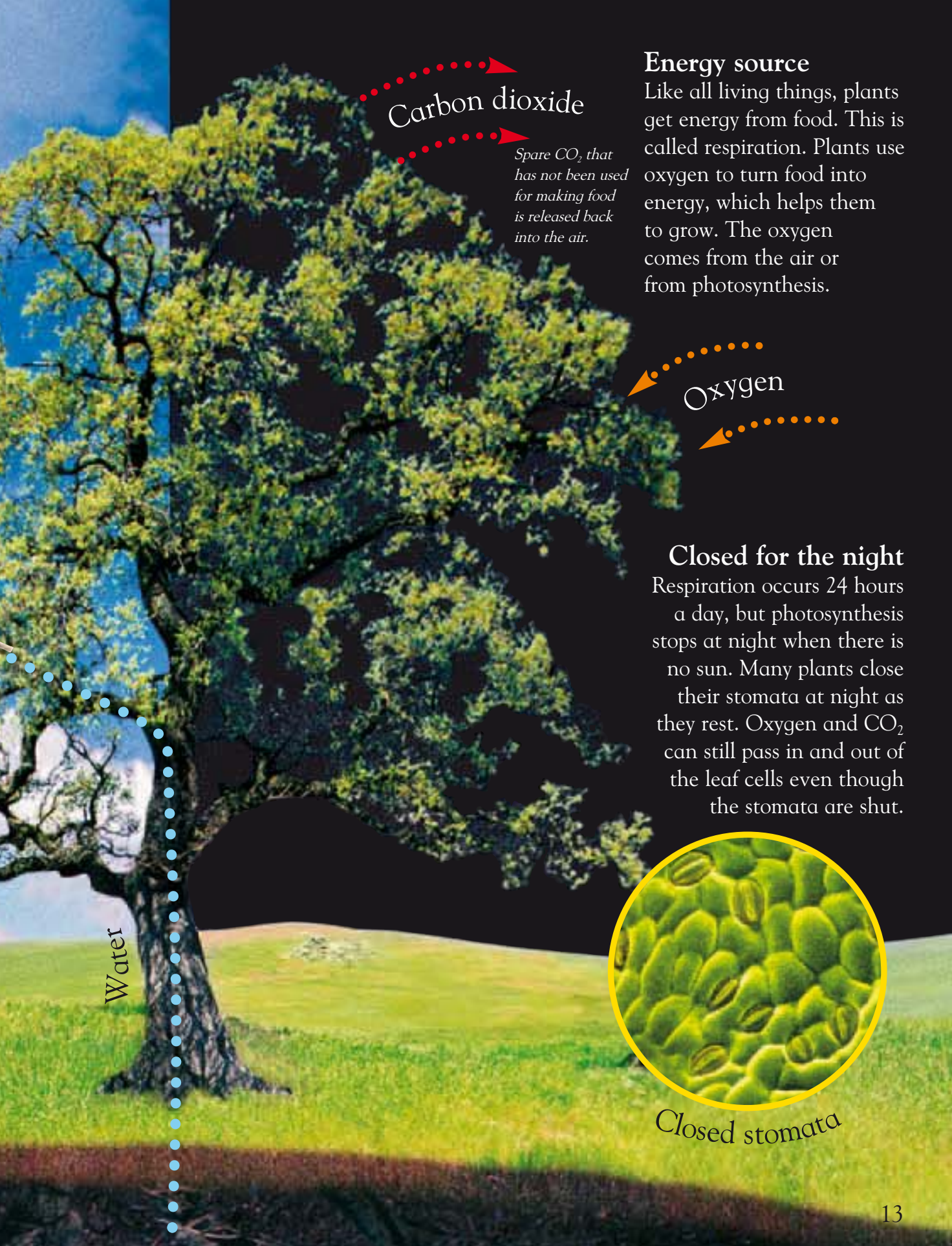




Carbon dioxide

Spare CO₂ that has not been used for making food is released back into the air.

Energy source

Like all living things, plants get energy from food. This is called respiration. Plants use oxygen to turn food into energy, which helps them to grow. The oxygen comes from the air or from photosynthesis.

Oxygen

Closed for the night

Respiration occurs 24 hours a day, but photosynthesis stops at night when there is no sun. Many plants close their stomata at night as they rest. Oxygen and CO₂ can still pass in and out of the leaf cells even though the stomata are shut.



Closed stomata

Water